

Meaning, significance and Evolution of society

What is society

- Society is well-known word for every individual living in the world.
- Human beings spend their life in a particular society till death; therefore they could not remain detached from the society.
- In fact there is a strong binding between individual and society.
- Interaction and relationship between individual and groups, and addition of humans by birth makeup a society.

What is society

- In general term we could say that when individuals and group of people contact and associate with each other, a society comes into being.
- “It is a system of relationships that exist among the members of human groups”. (Prof. Wright)
- “It is a large group where individual establishes relationships”. (A.W Green)

Evolution of society

- Societies evolve and develop gradually, as a social value advance so the societies become more and more modernized.
- These are the six stages of the evolution of human society:
 - Hunting & gathering society
 - Pastoral society
 - Horticultural society
 - Agricultural society
 - Industrial society
 - Post Industrial society

Stages of evolution of human society

- **Hunting and gathering society:** This was a primitive society where individuals started learning to live in social group. Men hunted and women gathered food. Family institute was also developed. It was starting of social life, but people were living a nomadic life settling nowhere permanently.
- **Pastoral society:** In this stage people had learnt the art of storage of food. Human groups managed to live by raising livestock, so they moved from one place to another in search of fodder. However they had developed social values.

Stages of evolution of human society

- **Horticultural society:** This is 3rd stage where people already knew how to cultivate plants. History shows evidence that in some parts of the world like Latin America, central Asia and Middle East, human beings cultivated food plants, fruit and vegetable first time. So people also started living permanently near the cultivated area they had acquired.
- **Agricultural society:** This is an advanced form of horticultural society. For the first time human started using technology to grow crops on large pieces of land. Feudal system is the example and very advanced stage of agricultural society.

Stages of evolution of human society

- **Industrial society:** In this stage people used complex machines like steam engine and other appliances. This society emerged and developed with the “Industrial Revolution”.
- **Post Industrial society:** This stage rightly defined is an upgraded form of Industrial society. Modernization and Industrialization caused massive changes in social structure of all societies. New values, new cultures and new civilizations are built and reformed in this stage. Rapid stage in human societies can easily be observed in this era, but unfortunately, as material comforts prevail spiritual values are vanishing day by day.

Significance of society

- **Here we discuss how society is important for a person as a member of all society.**
 - **Society plays significant role in growth of individual.**
 - **Society organizes individual groups by sharing their common problems then seeking solution afterward.**
 - **In society Individual is taught rules and regulation which regulate his/her life.**
 - **Society is a source of comfort and security for an individual.**
 - **Society proves pattern of relationship and identity for an individual.**
 - **Society provides all means of socialization.**
 - **Society fulfils all social needs and demands of individuals.**
 - **Every social member is a product or representation of his/her society.**

Pakistani society

- From 712 to 1857 (during Muslim rule in subcontinent) Muslim civilization became a strong cultural force throughout India even the Hindus adopted certain elements of Islamic culture.
- After British occupation in 1857, Muslim culture and Islamic traditions were deliberately damaged by the Hindus and British.
- Muslim league, founded in 1906, protected Muslim rights and saved Islamic culture and civilization.
- After a long struggle for independence finally Pakistan came into being in 1947. In 1950's speech of Liaqat Ali Khan in America defined aim of achievement of Pakistan which made it a real Islamic model.
- In short, Pakistani society is predominantly an Islamic society, where non-Muslims are allowed to live as respectable citizens.

ETHNICITY



INTRODUCTION

There are thousands of ethnic group found in the world and everyone has its own unique characteristics. Ethnicity is considered as basis of identity of an individual living in society. In Pakistan, people seem very much concerned about their ethnic identification; but why?



What is Ethnicity?

- Ethnicity refers to sharing of a common culture and similar way of life by an ethnic group. Its common elements are language, religion, culture, music, art etc.
- Ethnicity is basically an "in group or own group."
- The word 'ethnicity' is derived the Greek word 'ethos', used for "folk" and 'people' centuries ago
- The term ethnic group was first recorded in 1935 and inducted in Oxford English Dictionary in 1972 as synonym of ethnicity, nationality and citizenship.

Ethnicity and Nation

Though term Ethnicity mixes with nation because both have shared culture and common characteristics as a social group, but technically, these are two different terms in nature. The difference among ethnic group and nation are mentioned in the following.



Ethnicity and Nation

- Nation is combination of variety of sub-groups while ethnic group is a particular- group of nation. In other words, we could say that ethnic group is a part of nation as a sub-group.
- Nation or state bears boundaries and sovereignty but ethnic groups have no specific boundaries.
- Lot of ethnic groups could be merged in nation but lot of nations could not be inducted in ethnic group.

Ethnicity and Prejudice

Ethnicity is a source of social cohesion which integrates and associates a member with his/her group. Sometime it becomes a source of social prejudice, as well. It proves that the term ethnicity is a product of behaviour or individual acts whether constructive or destructive.

Ethnocentrism

Renowned sociologist William R. Sumner coined the term 'ethnocentrism'. William Sumner explains it as: "The technical name for the view of thinking in which one's own group is centre of everything, and all others are scaled and rated with reference to it. Love with your "in-group" is the source of solidarity. When individual makes his "in-group" as a criteria to judge other culture or "out-group", is "ethnocentrism".

Prejudice

- Prejudice is an unjustified or incorrect attitude towards other individual on the basis of different race, gender or religious group. In prejudicial frame of mind individual acts in irrational and emotional way, so it could be harmful for the society.
- Ethnocentrism is "objective approach" while prejudice is "subjective approach".
- Suppose if a Muslim loves Islam because it is the best way of life, it is "ethnocentrism", but if he loves Islam and hates other just because others are not Muslims it is "prejudice". Extremism is the best example of "prejudice".

Ethnicity in Pakistan

Pakistan is multi-ethnic country where various major and minor ethnic groups are found and every group has its own identity and style of living.



Ethnicity in Pakistan

- **Sindhis:** Lives in Sindh province and speak Sindhi language. They are 15% of total population.
- **Punjabis:** Consist of different tribes and dwells in Punjab province.
- **Pakhtuns:** This is second largest ethnic group and living since last five thousand years near Indus River. They make up 15% of total Pakistan's population.
- **Muhajirs:** They came from India after creation of Pakistan and speak "Urdu" as a mother tongue. They are settled mostly in Karachi, Hyderabad and Sukkar but are living in different urban and rural areas of Pakistan.

Ethnicity in Pakistan

- **Baluchs:** Settled in Balochistan and speak Baluchi. Their ethnic base is in Iran and their language is also inspired by Persian.
- **Kashmiris:** Live in Azad Kashmir and speak Kashmiri language. Their famous casts are Dar, Butt, and Lone, etc.
- **Brahvis:** Live in Baluchistan and speak Brahavi language. It is a small group of Afghan origin.
- **Seraikis:** Live in lower Punjab and speak Seraiki language.

In spite of these major groups, some small groups are living in Pakistan like Hazaras, Shinas and Kalash, etc. These groups are smaller in number but play significant role in the progress and prosperity of Pakistan.